Wasting diseases: Underweight also results from debilitating disease like tuberculosis, diabetes, malabsorption syndrome or cancer. Infections are common among them.

Poor food Intake: Diminished intake of food resulting due to 1) Psychological factors that cause a person to refuse to eat 2) loss of appetite or imbalance of the brain's hunger, satiety centers or 3) personal poverty and limited food supply.

Malabsorption syndrome: Poor nutrient absorption results from 1) prolonged diarrhoea 2) gastrointestinal disease 3) abuse of laxatives.



Anti obesity day is celebrated on 26th November.

Hormonal imbalance: Hyper-thyroidism increase the caloric needs of the body.

Energy Imbalance: Greatly increased physical activity without a corresponding increase in food brings an energy balance deficit.

Poor living status: An unhealthy home environment or no home at all results in irregular and inadequate meals.

Principles of Diet Therapy

A high calorie, high protein, high carbohydrate, moderate fat diet with good sources of vitamins and minerals.

Dietary Management

Energy: The calorie requirements vary depending upon the activities. The total calorie intake should be in excess of the energy requirement.

Proteins: Instead of 1 g of protein 1.2 g per kg/day is recommended.

Fat: Fat is added to increase the calories but it should not exceed the tolerance limits.

Carbohydrate: High carbohydrate is to provide primary energy source and should be provided in an easily digested form. The number of meals should be increased.

Vitamins and minerals: Liberal amount through proper diet should be given.

Fluids: Fluid should be taken after meal and not before or during meals.

Dietary Guidelines

- Good food of wide variety, well prepared, helps to revive lagging appetite and increase desire to eat.
- Energy dense food is preferred.
- Frequent small nourishing meals should be given.
- Concentrated food supplements can be given.
- Foods can be seasoned with ghee, butter, sauces and dressings.

1.6 Diet for Cardiovascular disease

Cardiovascular disease (CVD) generally refers to the disease of the heart and blood vessels, is a major cause of disability and premature death throughout the world and contributes to the escalating cost of health care in India. Compared to the western countries, CVD affects Indians atleast a decade earlier and in their most productive years.

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